

February 17, 2026

Dear Michael Sparks:

The Admissions Committee of the Department of Economics was very impressed with your application to our program. Unfortunately, we cannot admit all qualified applicants, and at this point we have placed you on a waitlist for admission to our Ph.D. program.

The applicants recommended by the Admissions Committee are a very impressive group of individuals. We seek to admit a class balanced across subfield interests, and whose research interests match the research interests of our faculty. We have placed you on our waitlist either because we believe you have the qualifications to succeed in our program, but your research interests are less well matched with those of our faculty, or because you are interested in subfields that have a usually high number of competitive applicants this year. We would be very glad to have you as a student in our Ph.D. program if a slot becomes available between now and our decision deadline of Wednesday, April 15, 2026.

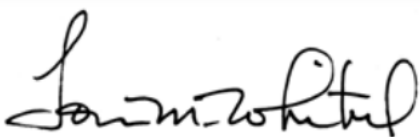
In recent years, many students in our incoming classes have been drawn from the waitlist. In the event you are moved off the waitlist and are accepted into the program, the Department will offer you a full five-year package of financial support.

We recognize that most applicants are applying to multiple Ph.D. programs, and you may be admitted to another program you would prefer to Michigan's. Please let us know at any point if you are no longer interested in remaining on our waitlist.

As a waitlisted applicant, you are welcome to attend the online portion of our Ph.D. Preview Week from March 9-11, 2026. If you are interested in attending the virtual Preview Week, please contact Laura Howe/Jacob Feeman (econgradapp@umich.edu).

Past experience suggests that we will not be in a position to admit applicants from the waitlist until relatively close to the April 15 deadline. If you have any questions about this letter or about our doctoral program, please feel to contact me at econdocad@umich.edu, or our graduate program coordinators, Laura Howe/Jacob Feeman, at econgradapp@umich.edu.

Sincerely,



Toni Whited
Professor of Economics and Director of Ph.D. Admissions
Department of Economics

